

# Topic: Neo colonialism and emergence of Bangladesh

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# Neo colonialism and emergence of Bangladesh

- The emergence of Bangladesh as an independent nation in 1971 was influenced by various historical, political, and economic factors, including the concept of neocolonialism. Neocolonialism refers to a form of indirect control and exploitation exercised by powerful countries or multinational corporations over less developed or newly independent nations. It often involves economic, political, and cultural domination rather than direct colonial rule.
- Here's how neocolonialism played a role in the emergence of Bangladesh:
  1. Colonial Legacy: Before gaining independence, Bangladesh was part of British India and later became East Pakistan after the partition of India in 1947. During the colonial period, the British Empire exploited the region's resources and established a system of economic and administrative control. This colonial legacy left Bangladesh with a weak economic base and a lack of self-determination.

# Neo colonialism and emergence of Bangladesh (continue)

2. Economic Exploitation: After the partition of India, East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) and West Pakistan (now Pakistan) were geographically separated by India. West Pakistan held most of the political and economic power and resources, while East Pakistan was economically disadvantaged and marginalized. The economic exploitation of East Pakistan by West Pakistan contributed to grievances and disparities, which fueled the desire for independence.

3. Political Oppression: The political elites in West Pakistan were accused of imposing their will on East Pakistan, leading to political oppression and discrimination against Bengalis, who were the majority population in East Pakistan. This political domination was seen as a form of neocolonialism, as the interests of the dominant West Pakistan were prioritized over those of the Bengali population.

# Neo colonialism and emergence of Bangladesh (continue)

4. Cultural Identity: The Bengali people had a distinct cultural and linguistic identity, which was often suppressed or ignored by the West Pakistani authorities. This cultural suppression and the denial of basic rights contributed to the demand for independence and the assertion of a unique Bengali identity.

5. Economic Dependence: East Pakistan was economically dependent on West Pakistan for trade, aid, and economic support. This economic dependence made it difficult for East Pakistan to pursue its own development and led to concerns about economic neocolonialism.

# Neo colonialism and emergence of Bangladesh (continue)

6. Independence Movement: The Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971 was a direct response to these economic, political, and cultural injustices. The people of East Pakistan, with the support of India, waged a war for independence against West Pakistan. This war culminated in the creation of the independent nation of Bangladesh on December 16, 1971.